Minutes NZRA general meeting, Monday 30 July 2012

Present: Pete Squires, Bill Kennedy, Grant Hunter, Emma de Lacey, Trevor Merrifield, Tim Farrant
Apologies: Nick Collins, Douglas Wood, Mark Copeland

Matters arising:
Australasian Champs series: Nick Collins reported that he is working with Australian counterparts on an agreement for an Australasian regional champs in the near future. This would rotate through NZ each 6 years.

NZ Champs 2012

- Bob Cunninghame, organiser, Otago reports he has a team of reliable local helpers. With agreement on entry fees and lower age limit (16 yrs or under must be accompanied by an adult (21+) for the 24 hour event) Bill will now get the event website up.
- Grant to ask Bob if he has local capability for (1) Navlight operations (2) course vetting, (3) donation payment for volunteer group (e.g. are they from an orienteering club?). Bill to talk to Bob about capability for computer mapping.
- Trophies. A reminder to Dave that these will need to be collected soon from last year's winners. Pete to also arrange engraved glasses for winners (will need about 100 - 12 divisions, 3 placings, 2.5/team).
- Junior trophy. Despite agreement two years ago to award a trophy for junior teams, we do not yet have these, mainly due to unresolved uncertainty about design etc. Agreed that Pete and Trevor will arrange to have these available (brass/wood?) for this year's event.

NZ Champs beyond 2012

- Grant to update/remind Stuart Payne (NZOF) on our agreement to meet in November to set a strategy and tactics for determining the location and organiser for future years.
- Received suggestion from Mark Copeland that given the challenges of confirming the organisation of the 24 hr NZ Rogaine Champs every year, we consider that any "major" New Zealand Rogaine, such as a twelve-hour, might be accorded NZ Champs status in any given year. The view of the meeting on this idea was that while conceding the ongoing challenges of delivering a 24 hour event, the notion of a shorter event was not really acceptable, and might lead to it becoming the norm. One main reason is that 24 hour event is required for pre-qualification for WRC. (There was greater preference at the meeting that a NZ champs event is not held in a year if there is no credible organiser or venue.). However, agreed that sustaining an annual 24-hour event is not a thing we can take for granted, and strategies require further thought. (An agenda item for above November meeting?)

NZ Rogaining rules

- Noted that we need to review/update rules for the minimum age for 24 hour events, based on our concern and one-off change for 2012.
- Also noted to review Navlight wristband use, as flagged by a rogainer concerned that all team members go to every check point. (i.e. should each team member wear one, or where just two are used, mixed teams of 3 or more have one worn by each gender?
- Agreed that these and any other rule reviews be handled at the above November meeting NZRA/NZOF.

National rogaine series

Douglas Wood reported on a possible format for the series:

- Six events - spread over 6 regions - NI - Northern , NI -Central, NI - Southern, SI - Northern, SI - Central, SI - Southern
- Nick will coordinate the selection of NI events
- Mondo and Douglas will sort out the South Island
- Preference is for longer 12 hr events, with 6hr as minimum
- Still finalizing the number of events that must be completed to qualify for Series Winner - Will be best of 3 or 4, with events spread over both islands.
- Main focus is to select the events so competitors can start planning for next year.

Feedback from the meeting to the planning team is good, keep up the good work! Need to also think about technical standards (presume they will be using the NZ rogaine rules as a guideline).

(Note that hosting three events in the NI plus a NZ champs 24-hour may be a tall order for the NI, especially if the series events are new ones? – Sec.)

Future events – Canterbury

- Christchurch city 'Metrogaine'. Tim, Pete and Douglas have had an initial meeting on a possible format. Thinking of a two-hour event that will be run twice on the same day, say 10-12 and 2-4. Aiming for early December. Douglas to contact CCC to see what help they can provide, also sort out a base for the event.
- Office hours. Grant is starting to look at a high country venue, possibly with separate Saturday and Sunday events, with overnight camping optional (come for one day or two). Possibly late February.
- Tim and team considering an event, possibly 12-hour, before Christmas.

Next meeting

- Good question, but pre-Christmas

Meeting ended. GG Hunter